

devices. The second concern is data security and how to keep all the information secure. The third concern is the overall security of the devices, in terms of the information that they carry. So basically, security and manageability are the two major concerns and roadblocks stopping customers from embracing this technology. Wherever we are able to engage in these conversations with the customers, and convince them on how we will address their security concerns, they come on board. We try to tell that with business mobility, the users do get flexibility yet the enterprise remains as secure as is possible.

Q What are the top three considerations that a company must look at while considering business mobility as a solution?

The top three considerations from the technology standpoint include heterogeneity, simplicity and having everything running on a secure infrastructure. What we tell our customers is that when you are making a transition to business mobility, make sure that these three aspects are the core design elements in your strategy. Heterogeneity is important, because if you build your strategy for business mobility adoption based on one application, one device or one platform, it will defeat the purpose. So you need to be prepared that whatever solution or platform that you are building supports any device—not only the devices available in the market today but also the devices that will come out in the future.

The second element is consumer grade simplicity. Enterprises generally have functionalities but what

they lack is simplicity. SAP as an application can do everything. It's not that SAP lacks functionality. What people struggle with when they use it, is its lack of simplicity. So user-friendliness is of prime importance.

Last, but not the least, all the applications need to run on a trusted infrastructure, because if you don't keep an infrastructure perspective while building all this, which is your cloud and data centre infrastructure, you will not be able to leverage all the investments and innovations that you have done in that space. These are the key elements to be kept in mind to enable business mobility.

Q What are the roadblocks that one can encounter while adopting business mobility?

If you build applications that align with these three key elements, the possibilities are that you may not have to face any roadblocks. But if you miss out on any one of these, the move to business mobility may not be as fruitful for the company as it should be. For instance, let's say the heterogeneity element is missed out, and someone takes the application-centric approach. After the application is operational, one may feel that the current infrastructure is good for that application but may not be suitable to run other applications. So, this needs to be checked at an early stage. Similarly, one cannot restrict an application to just one platform, like iOS or Android. There are so many platforms and so many devices available today, which needs to be considered before devising a business mobility strategy. **END** 

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